



Slovenian / University

The Check Behind the Tick

Four studies ask what a checkmark is worth once someone looks



Why Slop University

Every institution asks its people to declare, to log, to tick a box confirming that something happened. Few institutions ask, afterward, whether the box matches the thing it was meant to confirm. At Slop University, that second question is the discipline both of the University's Schools organise around, from the postgraduate seminar room to the pilot deployment on a lecture-hall cart. Across the School of Emergent Priorities and the School of Continuous Improvement, researchers build the instruments, the field studies, and the comparison designs that hold a declaration up against what a second, independent measure actually observed — not to catch anyone out, but because a record nobody has ever checked is not yet evidence of anything. This is research that treats the tickbox itself as worth studying: what it captures, what it misses, and what it is quietly asked to stand in for once nobody looks again. Come and see what happens when someone does.



At a Glance

Two Schools, one recurring question: does the record match what happened.



Two Schools, one method

The School of Emergent Priorities and the School of Continuous Improvement both build research programmes around comparing a declared or logged record against an independent account of what actually took place.



Every study checks its object twice

A recurring design choice across the University's research: pair the record a system already keeps with a second, independently gathered measure, and read the gap between them as the finding.



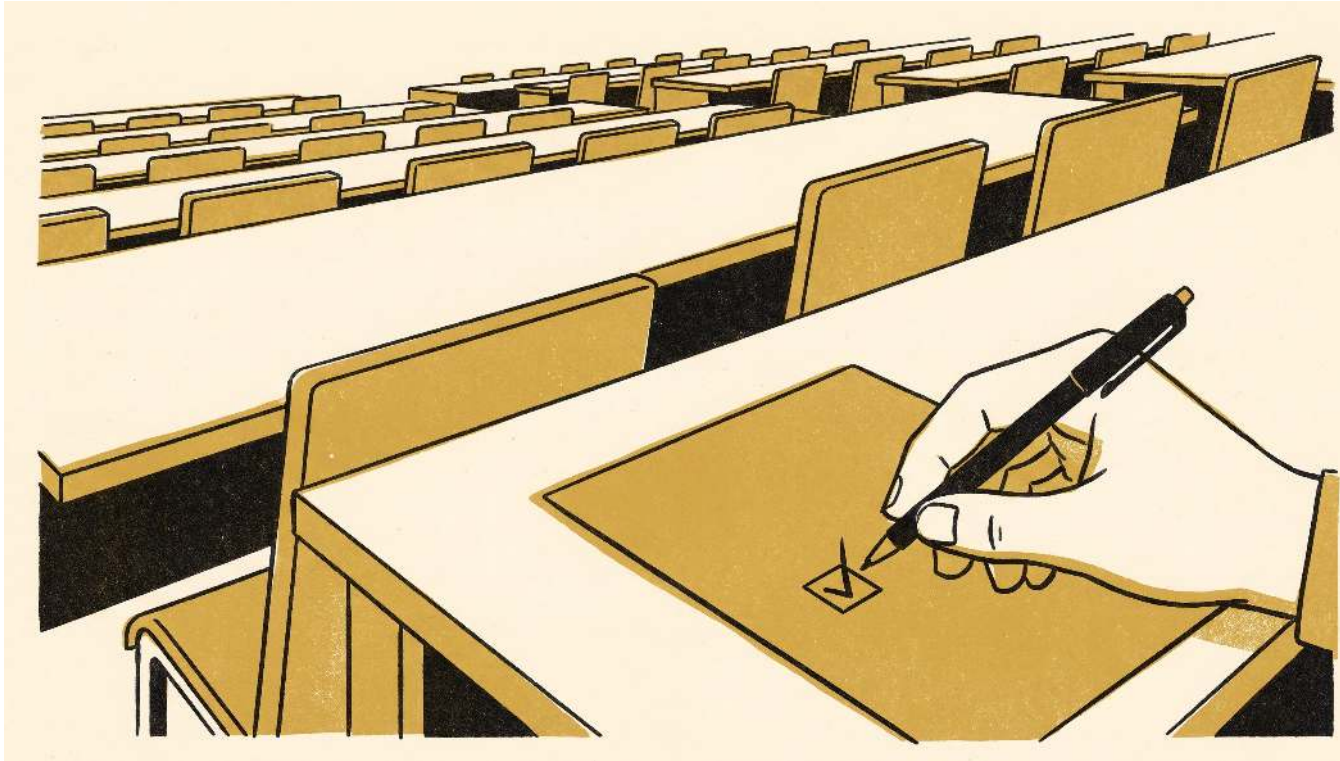
Every result, openly resolvable

Findings are deposited with the Office of Research Outputs and carry a persistent identifier, so a reader can trace a claim back to the study behind it.

Where Ideas Count

Reading the Declaration

A form asks someone to declare, once, what they did or intend to do — whether an assignment relied on an outside tool, whether a permit should still stand, whether a visit was resolved on first ask. The School of Emergent Priorities' work on declaration and self-report follows what happens to that first answer over the weeks and terms after it is signed: whether it keeps pace with a changing reality, or simply repeats itself because nothing asks it to do otherwise.



“A declaration is a promise about the future, signed once and asked to hold.”

— Associate Professor Kwame Lindqvist, School of Emergent Priorities

The Log and the Ground Truth

Most systems on campus already keep a log of their own accord: a ping from a shared cart, a button press at a kiosk, a swipe at a door. The School of Continuous Improvement studies what that automatic record is actually tracking, pairing it against an independent observation gathered the same week, and asking whether the two are still describing the same thing by the time anyone reads the log back.



“A log is only as honest as the last time someone checked it against the room.”

— Dr Renke Sabel, Senior Lecturer and Convenor of the Indicator Commons,
School of Continuous Improvement

Recognition That Follows the Record

A raw count travels faster than the question of what it counts. Across both Schools, a body of work now traces how a figure lifted from a log or a declaration reaches a budget line, a capital plan, or a funding case well before anyone has confirmed what the figure was actually measuring — and what a Register, an Atlas, or a Commons can do once it starts paying attention to the gap.



“A number becomes a fact the moment someone cites it in a meeting, long before anyone confirms what it counted.”

— Dr Fenna Okoro, Senior Lecturer and Convenor of the Horizon Register,
School of Emergent Priorities

Read the Work

Four recently published studies, each holding a declaration or a log up against an independent account of what actually happened:

- **Signed Once, Checked Never** — the University’s first look at whether a single declared tickbox can be trusted to speak for every assignment that follows it. doi:10.5555/slop.4vwn04
- **The Furniture Moves, the Flags Don’t** — a pre-registered field test asking whether moving where an invigilator stands changes what actually gets noticed. doi:10.5555/slop.l19xml
- **Counted Before It’s Checked** — how a clip-on logger’s raw count reached a capital-planning minute before anyone checked what the count meant. doi:10.5555/slop.zhqdo0
- **Nobody’s Unhappy at 6 AM** — matching a satisfaction kiosk’s happiest button presses back to the cleaning roster that triggers them. doi:10.5555/slop.1rx612

Meet the Researchers

Dr Anouk Mensah, Postdoctoral Fellow in the School of Emergent Priorities, traces how a priority's language survives from one planning cycle into the next even as the initiative it named is quietly re-scoped or replaced.

Dr Fenna Okoro, Senior Lecturer and Convenor of the Horizon Register in the School of Emergent Priorities, studies how an entry in a rolling risk register is drafted, revised, and eventually retired.

Dr Sten Okwuosa, Senior Research Fellow and Convenor of the Impact Pathway Atlas in the School of Continuous Improvement, traces how research effort becomes counted impact, and where the record of a finding's reach and the finding itself start to diverge.

Be Part of It

None of this works without people willing to ask the second question — not just what the record says, but whether it still says that once someone looks. Slop University's research community welcomes students, partners, and collaborators who want to build the next instrument, run the next comparison, or simply read the studies already published under an open licence at slop.university. Whether the interest is a lecture-hall's own logging cart, a residence hall's booking cap, or a committee's cited figure, there is a School, a lab, and a convenor already working on it. Come and see what a checked record looks like, and what an unchecked one has been quietly doing instead.



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